

50 Habits and Exercises

Food does the biggest part of the work, but it is exercise that **speeds up the burn**, shapes your body and makes the result last. Here you will find **30 exercises** that really help you lose weight — on the street, on the treadmill, at the gym or at home, each one with a **plan to build up** — and **20 habits** that, added together, make the difference.

How to use this: pick one **cardio** exercise (walking, cycling, swimming...) and do it **3 to 5 times a week**, following the progression plan. Add **2 days of strength training** (at the gym or at home) to fire up your metabolism. Take on the habits little by little — it is the sum of everything that really slims you down.

WALKING AND RUNNING

The simplest and cheapest way to burn fat — on the street, in the park or on the treadmill.

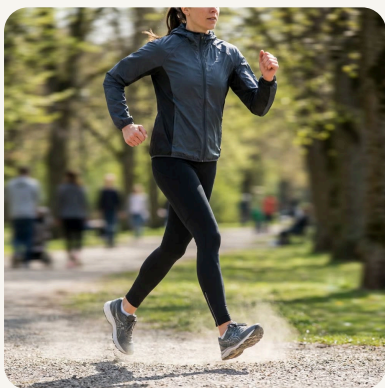


1 Walking

Street, park or treadmill **~150 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: 1.2 miles at a comfortable pace, 4 to 5 times a week. · Week 3-4: 2 miles, picking up the pace. · Week 5-6: 2.5 miles, with hills or a 3% incline on the treadmill. · Week 7+: 3 miles or 45 minutes at a strong pace.

Tip: Keep a pace where you can still talk, but with effort. On the treadmill, use a slight incline to burn more without running.

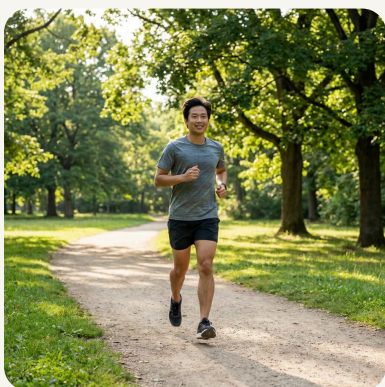


2 Power Walking

Street or treadmill **~200 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Once you are comfortable with 3 miles, alternate 3 minutes at a strong pace + 2 minutes normal, for 30 to 40 minutes. Slowly increase the fast stretches.

Tip: Pump your arms bent at 90 degrees and take firm steps. It burns almost as much as a jog, with no impact on your knees.

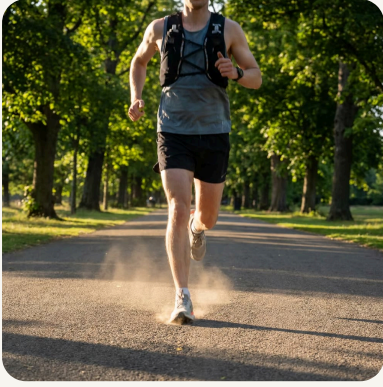


3 Jogging (Walk-Run Method)

Street, park or treadmill **~250 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: 1 minute of jogging + 2 minutes of walking, for 20 minutes. · Week 3-4: 2 minutes jogging + 1 minute. · Week 5-6: 3 minutes jogging + 1 minute. · Then: shorten the breaks until you run without stopping.

Tip: Take the jog slowly — if you run out of breath, slow down. That is how your body learns to run without suffering.



4 Continuous Running

Street, park or treadmill

~300 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: When you can run 20 minutes without stopping, add 5 minutes a week until you reach 40–45 minutes. Once a week, do a faster stretch.

Tip: A good pair of shoes makes all the difference for your knees. Run at a pace where you can breathe through your nose most of the time.

EXERCISES

CYCLING

It burns a lot of fat and goes easy on your knees — ideal for anyone carrying extra weight.

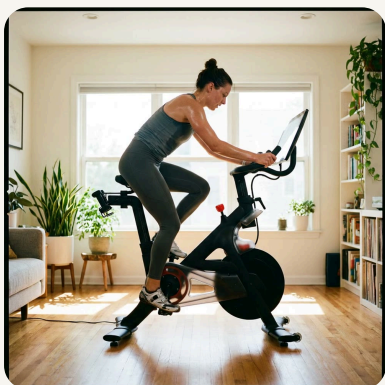


5 Outdoor Cycling

Street, bike path or park **~250 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: 20 minutes on flat ground. · Week 3-4: 30 minutes, with small hills. · Week 5+: 40 to 60 minutes, varying the pace.

Tip: Adjust the saddle: your leg should be almost straight with the pedal at the bottom. That protects your knee and lets you ride longer.



6 Stationary Bike

Home or gym **~250 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: 20 minutes on light resistance. · Week 3-4: 30 minutes, raising the resistance. · Then: 40 minutes alternating 2 minutes hard + 3 minutes light.

Tip: Perfect for rainy days. Raise the resistance little by little so you are not pedaling 'into thin air'.



7 Spinning

Gym **~350 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Start with 1 class a week and build up to 2 or 3. Follow the instructor, but respect your own limit on the resistance.

Tip: One of the classes that burns the most calories. Drink water during it and start with lower resistance — build up at your own pace.

EXERCISES

SWIMMING AND WATER EXERCISE

The water holds your body weight, so there is almost no impact — great for anyone with joint pain.



8 Swimming

Pool ~300 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Week 1-2: swim 20 minutes with breaks at the wall. · Week 3-4: shorten the breaks, reach 30 minutes. · Then: 40 continuous minutes, varying the strokes.

Tip: It works your whole body without overloading your knees and your spine. One or two lessons help a lot with your breathing.



9 Water Aerobics

Pool ~200 calories in 30 minutes

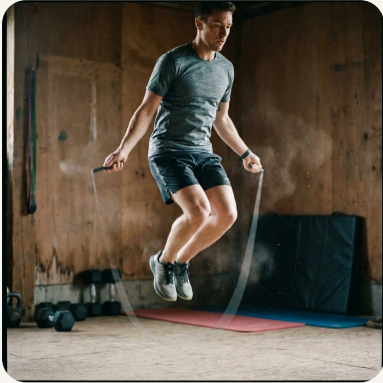
Progression: 1 to 3 classes a week. The intensity goes up as you push the movements harder against the water.

Tip: Done with energy, it burns plenty and strengthens your legs with zero impact. Excellent for anyone carrying a lot of extra weight.

EXERCISES

INTERVAL TRAINING (FAST BURN)

Little time, big results: it alternates hard effort with a short rest. It burns fat during and for hours afterward.



10 Jump Rope

Home, yard or gym **~350 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: 30 seconds jumping + 1 minute rest, for 10 minutes. · Week 3-4: 1 minute + 1 minute, for 15 minutes. · Then: 2 minutes + 1 minute, for 20 minutes.

Tip: One of the biggest burns per minute, and the rope is very cheap. Jump low, just enough for the rope to pass.

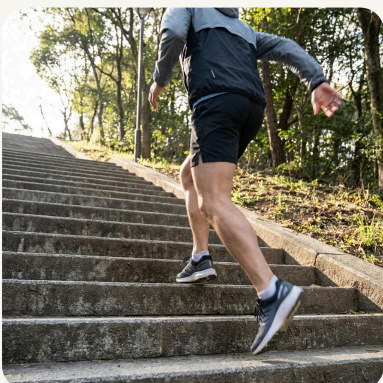


11 HIIT (Tabata)

Home or gym **~350 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: 4 exercises (jumping jacks, squats, running in place, plank): 20 seconds hard + 10 seconds rest on each, 4 rounds. Start with 10 minutes and build up to 20.

Tip: Short and intense. Your body keeps burning fat for hours afterward. 2 to 3 times a week is already enough for results.



12 Stair Climbing

Building, plaza or stair machine **~300 calories in 30 minutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: go up and down for 5 minutes, rest, repeat 3 times. · Then: blocks of 8 to 10 minutes. Always come down slowly to spare your knees.

Tip: It works your legs and your glutes hard while burning fat. Use the handrail to come down safely.



13 Jumping Jacks

Home or gym ~250 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Week 1-2: 30 seconds + 30 seconds rest, 8 rounds. · Week 3-4: 45 seconds + 20 seconds. · Then: 1 minute + 20 seconds, 10 rounds.

Tip: A great warm-up and a burn at the same time. Open your arms and legs together, at a steady rhythm.

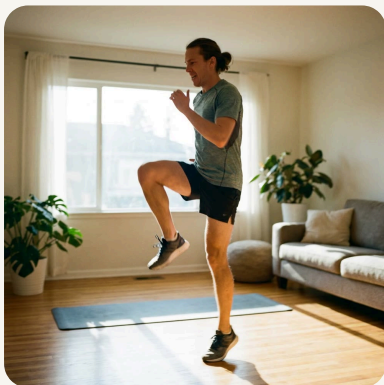


14 Burpees

Home or gym ~350 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Week 1-2: 5 burpees, rest, 4 rounds (without the jump if you need to). · Then: 8 to 10 per round, with the jump.

Tip: Squat, put your hands down, throw your legs back, come back and jump. It is intense and works your whole body — go at your own pace.



15 Running in Place (High Knees)

Home ~250 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Week 1-2: 30 seconds + 30 seconds rest, 8 times. · Then: 1 minute + 30 seconds, 10 times.

Tip: Run in place lifting your knees high. It fits in any little corner, without leaving home.

CLASSES AND DANCE

People who enjoy it do not quit. They burn a lot of fat without feeling like a sacrifice.



16 Dance (Zumba, Dance Fitness)

Home or gym ~300 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Start with 20 minutes following videos or a class and build up to 45–60 minutes. 3 to 5 times a week.

Tip: It does not even feel like exercise. Pick songs you love and do not stop moving — the sweat comes on its own.



17 Boxing / Muay Thai

Gym or a bag at home ~350 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: 1 class a week up to 3; or 3 rounds of 2 minutes on the bag, adding rounds little by little.

Tip: It releases stress and burns a lot. The technique comes with the classes — you do not need to arrive knowing it.

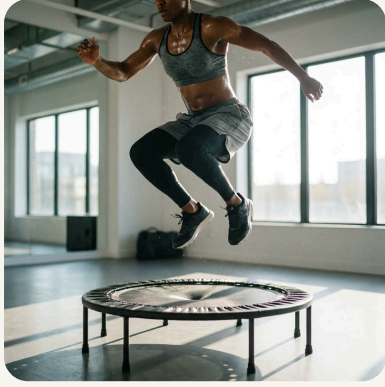


18 Step Class

Gym ~300 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: 1 class a week up to 3, following the choreography on the platform.

Tip: You step up and down from a platform in time with the music. It works your legs and your stamina hard.



19 Mini Trampoline (Rebounding)

Gym or home

~300 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Week 1-2: 15 minutes. · Then: 30 to 40 minutes of class.

Tip: Fun and low impact on your joints. Keep your abs firm to hold your balance.

GYM CARDIO MACHINES

They burn a lot of fat with low impact and let you control resistance, time and intensity.



20 Elliptical (Cross-Trainer)

Gym ~300 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Week 1-2: 20 minutes on light resistance. · Week 3-4: 30 minutes, raising the resistance. · Then: 40 minutes alternating 2 minutes hard + 3 minutes light.

Tip: It moves your arms and legs at the same time, with zero impact. Great for anyone whose knees hurt when running.



21 Rowing Machine

Gym ~300 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: Week 1-2: 5 minutes rowing + rest, 3 times. · Then: 20 to 30 continuous minutes, focusing on your technique.

Tip: It works almost every muscle at once. The power comes from your legs pushing, not just your arms pulling.

EXERCISES

WEIGHT TRAINING AT THE GYM

Muscle burns calories even at rest. Lifting speeds up your metabolism and stops your skin from going loose.



22 Full Body Workout (Beginner)

Gym ~200 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: 3 times a week, 1 exercise for each part: legs, back, chest, shoulders and abs. 3 sets of 12. Every 2 weeks, add a little weight.

Tip: At the start, focus on learning the right movement with light weight. Ask a trainer to set it up and correct you — it prevents injury.



23 Leg and Glute Workout

Gym ~250 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: 1 to 2 times a week: squats, leg press, leg extension and hip thrust. 3 to 4 sets of 12 to 15.

Tip: Your legs are the biggest muscles in your body — training them burns a lot of energy and helps you slim down faster.



24 Arm, Back and Chest Workout

Gym ~180 calories in 30 minutes

Progression: 1 to 2 times a week: lat pulldown, row, bench press and shoulder press. 3 sets of 12.

Tip: Strengthening your upper body improves your posture and shapes you while the fat comes off.

EXERCISES

STRENGTH AT HOME (NO EQUIPMENT)

No gym and no weights: your own body is the load. Build a circuit and gain muscle at home.



25 Squat

Home **legs and glutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: 3 sets of 10. · Week 3-4: 3 sets of 15. · Then: hold a heavy object (a water jug, a backpack) to add load.

Tip: Go down as if you were sitting in a chair, knees in line with your feet, back straight. It is the king of leg exercises.



26 Push-Up

Home **chest, arms and core**

Progression: Week 1-2: with your knees on the floor, 3 sets of 8. · Week 3-4: 3 sets of 12. · Then: with your legs straight.

Tip: If it is still hard, put your hands on a table or a wall. What matters is starting from where you can.



27 Lunge

Home **legs and balance**

Progression: Week 1-2: 3 sets of 8 with each leg. · Then: 3 sets of 12, and after that holding a weight in your hands.

Tip: Take a step forward and bend both knees until the back one almost touches the floor. It works one leg at a time.



28 Plank and Crunches

Home **the whole abdomen**

Progression: Hold the plank 20 to 40 seconds, 3 times, and do 3 sets of 15 crunches. (See Bonus 2 on Pilates for more core options.)

Tip: Strengthening your abs makes your belly firmer and improves your posture. Combine it with cardio to see the difference.



29 Resistance Band

Home **the whole body**

Progression: 3 sets of 12 to 15 on each movement (squat, row, curl, leg abduction). Move to a stronger band when it gets easy.

Tip: Cheap and it fits in a suitcase. It replaces gym weights at home and is great for your arms and your back.

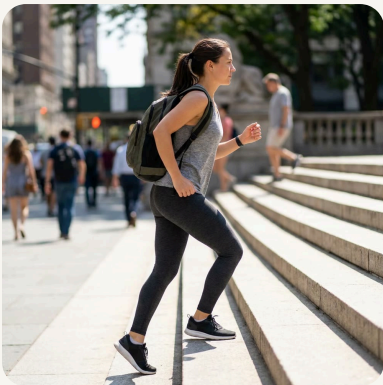


30 Step-Up

Home **legs and glutes**

Progression: Week 1-2: 3 sets of 10 with each leg. · Then: 3 sets of 15, and after that holding a weight.

Tip: Step up and down from a step or a sturdy chair. It is cardio and strength at the same time, and it works your glutes hard.



HABITS

MOVEMENT IN EVERYDAY LIFE

It is not only your workout that burns calories. These habits raise how much you burn all day long, without setting aside time for it.

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- 31 Set a goal of 8,000 steps a day.** Use your phone to count them. Having a number to hit makes you walk a lot more without noticing.
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- 32 Take the stairs instead of the elevator.** Small choices like this add up to a lot of energy burned by the end of the day.
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- 33 Park further away or get off one stop early.** Add steps to your day without having to set aside special time to walk.
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- 34 Stand up every hour if you work sitting down.** Staying still for a long time slows your body down. Stand up, stretch and walk a little.
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- 35 Walk while you are on the phone.** Turn time spent standing still into time spent moving, with no extra effort.
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- 36 Do your housework with energy.** Cleaning, cooking and tidying up also burn calories — treat it as movement, not just a chore.



HABITS

FOOD AND PORTIONS

No workout makes up for eating out of control. These habits, together with the recipes in this book, are what really make the fat come off.

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- 37 Have protein at every meal.** Egg, chicken, fish, lean meat or beans. It is the nutrient that fills you up most and protects your muscle while you lose fat.
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- 38 Start your plate with the salad and the vegetables.** They fill your stomach with few calories, so you eat less of the rest without going hungry.
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- 39 Use smaller plates and serve yourself only once.** Decide the portion before you eat. The same food looks like more on a small plate and you feel satisfied with less.
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- 40 Do not drink your calories.** Soda and boxed juice are pure sugar and do not fill you up. Go for water, tea or the detox juices in this book.
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- 41 Do not eat straight from the package.** Portion it into a bowl. Eating from the package, you lose track and eat far more than you need.
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- 42 Eat slowly and chew well.** Your brain takes about 20 minutes to tell you that you are full. Eating fast makes you overeat.
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- 43 Do not skip meals.** Built-up hunger leads to overdoing it at the next meal. Eating on schedule prevents losing control.
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- 44 Keep healthy snacks ready.** Fruit, plain yogurt or a handful of nuts save you from emergency hunger without falling into junk food.



HABITS

WATER, SLEEP AND REST

It is during rest that your body changes. Sleeping badly and living dehydrated sabotages any diet.

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- 45 Drink at least 2 quarts of water a day.** Your body confuses thirst with hunger. Well hydrated, you snack less and your metabolism works better.
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- 46 Start your day with a glass of water.** After hours of sleep, your body wakes up dehydrated. Water wakes your system up.
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- 47 Sleep 7 to 8 hours a night.** Bad nights increase your hunger and your craving for sweets the next day. Sleeping well also helps you lose weight.
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- 48 Have a chamomile tea at night (Recipe 147).** It helps you relax and fall asleep, improving your rest and your control over your appetite.
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- 49 Rest at least one day a week.** Muscle grows and your body recovers during rest. Training every single day without stopping gets in the way of your results.
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- 50 Stretch when you wake up and after your workouts.** It improves your flexibility, prevents soreness and gets your body ready to move more during the day.